Before our ICP workshop

Setup + materials to bring

Hi everyone,

In our 45-minute workshop, we'll build a portfolio reviewer that understands your work and a job you're interested in. Then we'll use the same context to practice an interview question aloud, get feedback, and try again.

Please complete the following before class so we can spend our time building and practicing together.

1. Test your setup

- Install or update Claude for desktop, sign in, and confirm your account can use Claude Code. Open the Code tab, choose a local folder, and send: "List the files in this folder. Do not change anything." If you get stuck, let me know before class.
- In regular Claude chat, start a short voice conversation and confirm you can speak to Claude and hear its response. This is separate from dictation in Code.
- Bring your laptop, charger, and headphones with a microphone.

2. Download the starter folder and add your materials

Download and unzip the attached portfolio-brain-starter.zip. Keep the provided references folder. Add your own files using the filenames below so the workshop prompts work without changing paths:

```
portfolio-brain/
  sources/
    resume.pdf
    portfolio-project.pdf
    project-notes.txt
    reflections.pdf
    relationship-map.pdf
  targets/
    job-description.txt
    company-notes.txt  (optional)
  references/  (provided)
    interview-question-bank.md
    IBM-CDO-Design-Interview-Questions.pdf
```

The starter includes the shared IBM CDO design-team question bank. Our interview coach will mix these educational examples with questions tailored to your target job. You don't need to prepare answers in advance.

What to include

- **resume.pdf:** Your current resume.
- **portfolio-project.pdf:** One case study you want feedback on. Include the project's visuals, captions, and written explanation. You can export existing pages or save screenshots together as a PDF.
- **project-notes.txt:** Short bullets explaining the brief, your specific role, who else contributed, key decisions, tools used, and outcomes. If an outcome is unknown, say so. Existing notes are fine.
- **reflections.pdf:** Your existing strengths/growth, leadership, decision-making, or other relevant homework. Combine what you already have; no need to write a new reflection.
- **relationship-map.pdf:** An export of your existing relationship map. Keep useful project and collaboration context; leave out private contact information.
- **job-description.txt:** One real role you're interested in. Paste the company, role title, original link, and complete job description, including responsibilities and qualifications. A link alone is not enough.
- **company-notes.txt, optional:** Relevant company research or notes from your Miro board. Keep your own interpretations separate from direct quotes or employer statements.

Make sure the text in your PDFs is readable. Export the relevant Miro content rather than relying only on a board link. If you can't export something, bring a readable text copy or screenshots.

3. Bring the folder to class

Keep it together on your laptop and be ready to open `portfolio-brain` in Claude Code. You don't need to create ICP.md, install skills, or build the reviewer in advance, we'll do that together.

We'll practice in pairs and coach after each answer. Bring one project you're comfortable discussing with a classmate.

If you have trouble accessing Code, using voice, or preparing a file, reply before class so we can sort it out.

See you there,
Micah